

Discounts are not given at the checkout, but instead “banked” in an account that can be cashed out or transferred to a bank account.

With digital coupons, the redemption rate can be as high as 15 to 20 percent, versus the 1 percent redemption rate of paper coupons, so what’s to stop mobile coupons from completely replacing paper?

Me, or people like me.

Keep in mind my initial resistance to joining Facebook. The same technophobia that made me resist signing up for Facebook has prevented me from purchasing and using a Smartphone. Then there is also the high price of the phone itself. Perhaps one of the reasons that more digital coupon users have higher incomes is because they can afford the computers, printers, and Smartphones. We also need to consider the “user apathy” mentioned in a Juniper Research November 2009 report on mobile coupons, “Mobile Coupons & NFC Smart Posters: Strategies, Applications & Forecasts 2009–2014.” The report found that user apathy and a lack of willingness to change and learn new technology are potential road blocks in the mobile industry. John Q. Public (or Mary P. Kenyon) just might not be willing to learn a new method of making financial transactions. Sure, I’m now comfortable downloading and printing out a coupon, but I have just as many friends in my age group who have never downloaded a coupon as those that have. And remember, the coupon programs are not without their own kinks. Sometimes the application doesn’t work, and I have to update the program in order to use it. Unless I lose my scissors, I don’t have a similar problem with my paper coupons. When I go to the store with a fully-stocked coupon box, I can just shuffle through the organized